/

WORK EDITION

70 AI shortcuts for knowledge work

Type a short slash word, add a few details, get a consistently good answer. Nothing to install. Just better ways to ask.

START HERE

How slash commands work

They're not a secret feature. They're a clear way to ask.

When you type something like /**tldr** into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or another AI, it reads the word as your intent and gets to work. Nothing needs to be installed or switched on. The slash simply marks a short, memorable label for what you want.

The real trick is what comes after the word. Each command in this guide pairs the slash word with the details that make the answer reliably good: who it's for, the length, the format, what you need from it. That's what turns a vague answer into a useful one.

```
/agenda 45-min vendor review, 5 people, decide on renewal
```

The slash word	The details	The outcome
Tells your AI the job.	How long, who, what kind.	What the work has to produce.

1

Type the word

Start a new chat and type the command, like /email.

2

Add the details

Follow the “Add” line. Paste your own notes, not company files.

3

Refine it

Reply “shorter,” “more direct,” or “as a table.”

GOOD TO KNOW

- These are shortcuts your AI understands, not official features. Results vary a bit by model.
- If your app shows a menu when you type /, keep typing or press Esc.
- Works in ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Grok, Copilot and others.

STAY SAFE

- Never paste confidential, client or company data.
- Follow your employer's AI policy. When in doubt, ask.
- Check numbers, names and quotes before anything leaves your desk.

01	Email	10 commands
02	Meetings	10 commands
03	Summarizing and reading	10 commands
04	Analysis and decisions	10 commands
05	Spreadsheets and data	10 commands
06	Decks and documents	10 commands
07	Planning and focus	10 commands

IF YOU ONLY LEARN TEN

The Top 10

The ones that give back an hour in the first week.

1 /tldr

TOO LONG; DIDN'T READ

Gives you the short version of anything long.

```
/tldr in 3 bullets, then one line on what I should do
```

2 /email

Drafts a clear work email from a few notes.

```
/email ask finance for Q3 numbers by Friday, friendly
```

3 /agenda

Builds a timed agenda with a clear goal.

```
/agenda 30-min kickoff, 6 people, agree on scope
```

4 /actions

Pulls owners, tasks and dates from notes.

```
/actions (paste notes) as a table: owner, task, due
```

5 /bluf

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

Rewrites a message so the point comes first.

```
/bluf (paste a long update to your director)
```

6 /formula

Writes a spreadsheet formula and explains it.

```
/formula Sheets: sum column C where column A says "Okinawa"
```

7 /decisionlog

Records a decision, the options and why.

```
/decisionlog we chose vendor B, here's why...
```

8 /outline

Builds a structure before you write.

```
/outline 10-min talk on AI at work for managers
```

9 /prioritize

Ranks your tasks by impact and urgency.

```
/prioritize (paste to-do list) I have 3 focus hours today
```

10 /tighten

Cuts an email down to what matters.

```
/tighten get this under 100 words
```

01 Email

Clear messages, sent faster.

/email

Drafts a clear work email from a few notes.

ADD Who it's to, what you need, and by when.

```
/email ask finance for Q3 numbers by Friday, friendly
```

/reply

Drafts a reply to an email you paste in.

ADD Paste the email, then what you want to say back.

```
/reply decline the meeting, offer a written update instead
```

/tighten

Cuts an email down to what matters.

ADD Paste your draft and a target length.

```
/tighten get this under 100 words
```

/bluf

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

Rewrites a message so the point comes first.

ADD Paste the message.

```
/bluf (paste a long update to your director)
```

/followup

Writes a polite nudge when you're waiting.

ADD What you asked, when, and the new deadline.

```
/followup on the contract draft I asked for last Tuesday
```

/pushback

Says no or not yet, professionally.

ADD The request and your reason.

```
/pushback can't take on the event, team is at capacity until May
```

/tone

Checks how your message might land.

ADD Paste it and say who's reading.

```
/tone how does this read to a frustrated client?
```

/escalate

Raises a problem upward, calmly and with facts.

ADD The issue, impact, and what you need.

```
/escalate vendor missed 2 deadlines, launch at risk
```

/intro

Writes a short introduction between two people.

ADD Who they are and why they should talk.

```
/intro our web lead to the new IT contractor
```

/inbox

Sorts pasted subject lines into reply, delegate, ignore.

ADD Paste subject lines only, not message bodies.

```
/inbox (paste 20 subject lines)
```

02 Meetings

Shorter meetings that end in decisions.

/agenda

Builds a timed agenda with a clear goal.

ADD Length, attendees, and the decision needed.

```
/agenda 30-min kickoff, 6 people, agree on scope
```

/prep

Gets you ready for a meeting.

ADD Who's in it, the topic, and your goal.

```
/prep budget meeting with my VP, I need one more hire
```

/minutes

Turns rough notes into clean minutes.

ADD Paste your notes.

```
/minutes (paste notes) decisions first, then discussion
```

/actions

Pulls owners, tasks and dates from notes.

ADD Paste the notes. Ask for a table.

```
/actions (paste notes) as a table: owner, task, due
```

/recap

Writes the follow-up email after a meeting.

ADD Paste notes and who's getting it.

```
/recap to the client, friendly, 5 lines max
```

/questions

Lists sharp questions to ask in a meeting.

ADD The topic and what you're worried about.

```
/questions for a vendor demo of a new scheduling tool
```

/standup

Formats your update: done, next, blocked.

ADD A few rough notes on your week.

```
/standup finished the survey, starting the report, waiting on IT
```

/icebreaker

Suggests a quick, low-cringe opener.

ADD Group size and how well they know each other.

```
/icebreaker 8 people, first workshop together, 5 minutes
```

/facilitate

Plans how to run a working session.

ADD The goal, time, and group.

```
/facilitate 90-min brainstorm on next year's events, 10 people
```

/nomeeting

Checks whether this could be an email.

ADD The meeting's purpose and attendees.

```
/nomeeting weekly status, 12 people, mostly updates
```

03 Summarizing and reading

Get the point without reading every word.

/tldr

TOO LONG; DIDN'T READ

Gives you the short version of anything long.

ADD Paste the text. Say how short.

```
/tldr in 3 bullets, then one line on what I should do
```

/keypoints

Pulls out the main arguments and evidence.

ADD Paste the text and your purpose.

```
/keypoints from this industry report, for a team briefing
```

/whatchanged

Compares two versions and lists the changes.

ADD Paste both versions.

```
/whatchanged old policy vs. new policy
```

/explainlike

Explains a topic for a specific audience.

ADD The topic and the audience.

```
/explainlike our budget process, for a new supervisor
```

/glossary

Builds a glossary of terms in a document.

ADD Paste the text.

```
/glossary for this technical spec, plain English
```

/critique

Finds weak spots in an argument.

ADD Paste the piece and who it's for.

```
/critique this proposal as a skeptical CFO
```

/faq

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Turns a long document into questions and answers.

ADD Paste the document and the audience.

```
/faq from this new leave policy, for staff
```

/quotes

Finds the most quotable lines in a text.

ADD Paste the text. Check quotes against the source.

```
/quotes 3 best lines from this interview transcript
```

/readinglist

Suggests what to read to get up to speed.

ADD The topic and how much time you have.

```
/readinglist AI governance basics, 3 hours
```

/briefing

Writes a one-page brief for a busy reader.

ADD Paste notes or text. Name the reader.

```
/briefing for my CEO on the new travel rules
```

04 Analysis and decisions

Think it through, then write it down.

/prosandcons

Lays out honest pros and cons.

ADD The decision and what matters most.

```
/prosandcons moving our newsletter to weekly
```

/decisionlog

Records a decision, the options and why.

ADD The decision, options considered, and reasons.

```
/decisionlog we chose vendor B, here's why...
```

/swot

STRENGTHS, WEAKNESSES, OPPORTUNITIES, THREATS

Runs a quick strengths-weaknesses check.

ADD The project or idea and the context.

```
/swot launching a member app next spring
```

/rootcause

Asks why until it finds the real cause.

ADD The problem and what you've seen.

```
/rootcause event signups dropped 30% this year
```

/premortem

Imagines the project failed, then lists why.

ADD The project and its timeline.

```
/premortem website redesign launching in 8 weeks
```

/options

Generates options you haven't thought of.

ADD The problem and your limits.

```
/options cut print costs 20% without losing reach
```

/weigh

Scores options against your criteria.

ADD The options and what matters, with weights.

```
/weigh 3 tools on cost, ease, support, as a table
```

/devil

Argues the other side so you're ready for it.

ADD Your position.

```
/devil argue against a 4-day work week pilot
```

/assumptions

Lists the assumptions hiding in a plan.

ADD Paste the plan.

```
/assumptions in this launch plan, ranked by risk
```

/tradeoffs

Shows what you give up with each choice.

ADD The choices.

```
/tradeoffs hire a contractor vs. train someone internally
```

05 Spreadsheets and data

Formulas, tables and charts without the guesswork.

/formula

Writes a spreadsheet formula and explains it.

ADD Excel or Sheets, your columns, and the result you want.

```
/formula Sheets: sum column C where column A says "Okinawa"
```

/fixformula

Finds why a formula isn't working.

ADD Paste the formula and the error.

```
/fixformula =VLOOKUP(A2,B:C,3,0) gives #REF!
```

/pivot

Walks you through building a pivot table.

ADD Your columns and the question you're asking.

```
/pivot total sales by month and region
```

/cleandata

Gives steps to tidy messy data.

ADD Describe the mess. Use sample rows, not real data.

```
/cleandata names in mixed case, extra spaces, duplicates
```

/chart

Suggests the right chart for your point.

ADD What the data shows and who's looking.

```
/chart 12 months of web traffic for a board slide
```

/insights

Spots patterns in a small table you paste.

ADD Paste anonymized numbers and your question.

```
/insights what stands out in these monthly totals?
```

/regex

Writes a pattern to find or clean text.

ADD What to match, with an example.

```
/regex pull 5-digit zip codes out of an address column
```

/macro

Writes a simple script to automate a task.

ADD Excel or Sheets and the steps you repeat.

```
/macro Apps Script: email me when column D says Overdue
```

/datacheck

Lists sanity checks before you share numbers.

ADD What the numbers are and where they're going.

```
/datacheck survey results going to leadership
```

/explaindata

Turns numbers into two plain sentences.

ADD Paste the figures and the audience.

```
/explaindata for staff: attendance up 12%, cost per head down
```

06 Decks and documents

Structure first, then the words.

/outline

Builds a structure before you write.

ADD Topic, audience, and length.

```
/outline 10-min talk on AI at work for managers
```

/slides

Drafts slide titles and one point each.

ADD The talk, audience, and slide count.

```
/slides 8 slides, quarterly results, headline titles
```

/onepager

Fits a proposal on one page.

ADD The idea, the cost, and the ask.

```
/onepager pilot a staff AI training program
```

/rewrite

Rewrites a passage for a new audience.

ADD Paste it and name the audience.

```
/rewrite this policy for frontline staff, 8th-grade level
```

/headline

Suggests clear titles and subject lines.

ADD What it's about and the reader.

```
/headline 5 options for an internal newsletter story
```

/speakernotes

Writes notes to say alongside each slide.

ADD Paste slide titles and your time limit.

```
/speakernotes 12 minutes, conversational
```

/sop

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Turns how you do something into a procedure.

ADD The task and the steps as you'd explain them.

```
/sop how we post an event to the website
```

/proposal

Drafts a short proposal with the ask up front.

ADD Problem, solution, cost, and decision needed.

```
/proposal new signage system, $12k, approve by June
```

/bio

Writes a short professional bio.

ADD Your role, experience, and length.

```
/bio 80 words, conference speaker, third person
```

/plainlanguage

Strips jargon from a document.

ADD Paste the text.

```
/plainlanguage (paste a policy paragraph)
```

07 Planning and focus

Decide what matters, then protect the time.

/prioritize

Ranks your tasks by impact and urgency.

ADD Your list and your deadlines.

```
/prioritize (paste to-do list) I have 3 focus hours today
```

/weekplan

Builds a realistic plan for your week.

ADD Tasks, meetings, and your best hours.

```
/weekplan 4 projects, 9 meetings, I focus best before 10
```

/okr

OBJECTIVES AND KEY RESULTS

Turns a goal into objectives and measurable results.

ADD The goal and the time frame.

```
/okr grow app downloads this quarter
```

/raci

RESPONSIBLE, ACCOUNTABLE, CONSULTED, INFORMED

Sorts out who does, decides and is told.

ADD The project, tasks, and people.

```
/raci website relaunch, 5 people, as a table
```

/breakdown

Breaks a big project into steps.

ADD The project and the deadline.

```
/breakdown annual report due in 6 weeks
```

/timeline

Builds a backwards timeline from a deadline.

ADD The deadline and major steps.

```
/timeline event on Nov 20, work back from there
```

/eod

END OF DAY

Writes a quick end-of-day wrap-up.

ADD What you did and what's next.

```
/eod for my manager, 3 bullets
```

/delegate

Writes a clear hand-off for a task.

ADD The task, who it's for, and what done looks like.

```
/delegate monthly report to a new analyst
```

/unstuck

Gets you moving when you're stalled.

ADD What you're avoiding and why.

```
/unstuck I've put off this budget memo for a week
```

/retro

Runs a quick look back after a project.

ADD What happened and the team's notes.

```
/retro summer campaign: what worked, what didn't, next time
```

KEEP GOING

Make your own

Any short word works if the details are good.

THE RECIPE

- Pick a word you'll remember: /weeklyreport, /clientupdate.
- Write the details you always end up adding.
- Save the full line in a notes file or text expander and paste it next time.

WHEN AN ANSWER MISSES

- Say what's wrong: “too long,” “too formal,” “my boss wants numbers first.”
- Ask it to ask you questions first: add “ask me 3 questions before you start.”
- Start a fresh chat if it gets muddled.

ONE TO BETTER

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YOUR OWN COMMANDS

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